

Tuesday, 23 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 36° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 35° 18°	MANCHESTER Overcast 32° 20°	GLASGOW Overcast 26° 18°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-----------------------------------	--------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Why did Keir Starmer resign and what could happen next?.

The Labour leader says he will remain prime minister until his successor is chosen.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Ex DUP leader Donaldson guilty of child sex abuse charges including one of rape.

The former MP is remanded in custody while he awaits sentencing for 18 offences.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Temperatures could hit 40C in UK as rare red heat warning issued.

The Met Office has issued a red weather warning over the coming days with the peak due on Wednesday and Thursday.

UK · NEWS
- 4

Injured ticket inspector who helped others in Bedford train crash hailed a hero.

A passenger praises a member of railway staff who, despite being in pain, helped the injured.

UK · NEWS
- 5

Boy, 3, no longer critical after crocodile attack.

The boy's condition "is no longer critical", police say.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 Clive Davis, music mogul behind Whitney Houston and Bruce Springsteen, dies aged 94.**
The record company executive also worked with Billy Joel, Pink Floyd, Alicia Keys and Aerosmith.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Late singer Oliver Tree's body returned to US after helicopter crash.**
The 32-year-old California native died whilst on his world tour, ahead of a date in Brazil.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Johnny Marr to auction guitars he played with The Smiths and Billie Eilish.**
The Smiths musician says he's selling his collection to stop his studio from becoming a museum.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Ozzy Osbourne's concert throne to go on display.**
The display coincides with the anniversary of the Back to the Beginning concert on 5 July.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Sturgeon and Gove to team up for reality TV 'wargame'.**
The former first minister is to serve as deputy prime minister in a simulation of a Russian attack on the UK.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Ex-Wimbledon champion Vondrousova given four-year ban.**
Former Wimbledon champion Marketa Vondrousova is banned for four years for refusing an anti-doping test in December 2025.
SPORT · UK
- 2 The key differences between Tuchel and Southgate's England teams.**
Analysing the similarities and differences between how Gareth Southgate and Thomas Tuchel led England.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Uncapped Coles picked for England T20 squad.**
Sussex all-rounder James Coles is called up by England for their T20 series against India.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Itoje rested as Caluori among five England call-ups.**
England captain Maro Itoje will miss England's Test against South Africa on 4 July after being left out of the entirety of the summer's Nations Championship action.
SPORT · UK
- 5 'Brilliant finish' - Messi becomes all-time leading World Cup scorer.**
Lionel Messi makes history as the all-time leading World Cup scorer, netting his 17th tournament goal during Argentina's game against Austria.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that spending time looking at classic works of art can genuinely boost your mood.**
Researchers found that even a few minutes admiring beautiful paintings or sculptures can lead to feelings of calm and contentment. It seems a little dose of culture might be just what the doctor ordered!
- 2 The enduring appeal of 'board games' is experiencing a significant resurgence, with families and friends rediscovering the joy of unplugged fun.**
From classic chess to modern strategy games, people are finding that gathering around a table for a game night is a wonderful way to connect and create lasting memories, away from screens.
- 3 Gardening experts are championing the benefits of 'container gardening' for those with limited space.**
Even a small patio or balcony can be transformed into a vibrant green oasis with cleverly arranged pots and planters. It's a fantastic way to enjoy nature's bounty, no matter the size of your garden.
- 4 A charming trend sees people embracing the art of 'letter writing' once again, sending thoughtful notes to loved ones.**
In an age of instant messages, a handwritten letter feels wonderfully personal and special. It's a lovely way to show someone you're thinking of them and create a tangible keepsake.
- 5 Research into 'memory lane' moments suggests that certain everyday sounds are particularly good at triggering nostalgic feelings.**
The clink of teacups, the distant sound of an ice cream van, or the distinctive chime of a clock can all whisk us back to happy childhood memories in an instant.
- 6 The humble 'picnic' is being celebrated as a perfect way to enjoy the outdoors and good company without much fuss.**
Whether it's a simple sandwich in the park or a more elaborate spread by the river, packing a basket and heading out for an al fresco meal is a quintessentially British delight.
- 7 A new appreciation for 'star gazing' is encouraging more of us to look up at the night sky.**
Away from city lights, the sheer wonder of the stars and planets can be a truly humbling and beautiful experience. It's a reminder of the vastness of the universe above us.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with the car radio volume when a really good song comes on?

ANSWER: WINDING IT UP TO ELEVEN, EVEN IF YOU'RE JUST NIPPING TO THE SHOPS!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'annoyance' instantly makes them sigh and mentally roll their eyes. What came out on top?

ANSWER: DISCOVERING SOMEONE ELSE HAS LEFT ONE SQUARE OF TOILET ROLL ON THE HOLDER!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'food combination' that sounds a bit odd on paper, but turns out to be absolutely delicious?**

Perhaps it's a quirky sandwich filling, an unusual topping for a dessert, or a mix of flavours that just shouldn't work but does! What's your favourite unexpected food pairing that you swear by?

- **We all have those little 'superstitions' or 'rituals' that we follow, even if we don't really believe in them.**

It might be touching wood, avoiding walking under ladders, or having a 'lucky' item of clothing. What's your most peculiar personal superstition or ritual that you just can't seem to shake?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Penguins have a special gland that filters salt out of seawater, allowing them to drink it.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies can communicate with each other over long distances by changing the colours of their wings in specific patterns.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the frisbee was cremated and his ashes were moulded into frisbees after he died.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's largest known snowflake was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, reported in Montana in 1887.
- Scotland's national animal is the unicorn.
- There are more possible permutations of a standard deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- Before erasers, people used wads of bread to rub out pencil marks.
- The 'king' of hearts in a deck of cards is the only king without a moustache.

On this day

Day 174 of the year, 191 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelthryth; Christian feast day: Joseph Cafasso; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Raffaella Cimatti; Christian feast day: Marie of Oignies. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — Randy Jackson, American bass player and producer
- 1986 — Christy Altomare, American actress and singer-songwriter
- 1966 — Chico DeBarge, American singer and pianist
- 1969 — Martin Klebba, American actor, producer, and stuntman
- 1965 — Paul Arthurs, English guitarist
- 1916 — Len Hutton, English cricketer and soldier (died 1990)
- 1978 — Memphis Bleek, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1962 — Chuck Billy, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 2016 — The United Kingdom votes in a referendum to leave the European Union, by 52% to 48%.
- 1969 — Warren E. Burger is sworn in as Chief Justice of the United States Supreme Court by retiring Chief Justice Earl Warren.
- 1972 — Watergate scandal: U.S. President Richard M. Nixon and White House Chief of Staff H. R. Haldeman are taped talking about illegally using the Central Intelligence Agency to obstruct the Federal Bureau of Investigation's investigation into the Watergate break-ins.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The last of Syria's declared chemical weapons are shipped out for destruction.
- 1947 — The United States Senate follows the United States House of Representatives in overriding U.S. President Harry S. Truman's veto of the Taft–Hartley Act.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — Watergate scandal: U.S. President Richard M. Nixon and White House Chief of Staff H. R. Haldeman are taped talking about illegally using the Central Intelligence Agency to obstruct the Federal Bureau of Investigation's investigation into the Watergate break-ins.

- 1973 — A fire at a house in Hull, England, which kills a six-year-old boy is passed off as an accident; it later emerges as the first of 26 deaths by fire caused over the next seven years by serial arsonist Peter Dinsdale.
- 2016 — The United Kingdom votes in a referendum to leave the European Union, by 52% to 48%.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 175 of the year, 190 days left in 2026. Today Army Day or Battle of Carabobo Day (Venezuela); Bannockburn Day (Scotland); Christian feast day: Gohard; Christian feast day: Joseph Yuan. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1960 — Siedah Garrett, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1961 — Curt Smith, English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1979 — Mindy Kaling, American actress and producer
- 1935 — Terry Riley, American composer and educator
- 1945 — Colin Blunstone, English singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Stuart Broad, English cricketer
- 1985 — Tom Kennedy, English footballer
- 1961 — Iain Glen, Scottish actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2022 — In *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization*, the U.S. Supreme Court rules that the U.S. Constitution does not assign the authority to regulate abortions to the federal government, thereby returning such authority to the individual states. This overturns the prior decisions...
- 1989 — Jiang Zemin succeeds Zhao Ziyang to become the General Secretary of the Chinese Communist Party after the 1989 Tiananmen Square protests and massacre.
- 1981 — The Humber Bridge opens to traffic, connecting Yorkshire and Lincolnshire. It remained the world's longest bridge span for 17 years.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1939 — Siam is renamed Thailand by Plaek Phibunsongkhram, the country's third prime minister.
- 1963 — The United Kingdom grants Zanzibar internal self-government.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)